

Columbia Animal Hospital walk-in

1409 Hwy 98E · (601) 736-3041 · Mon–Fri 7:30–5:30, Sat 8:00–12:00. Doctors:
Pat Sanford (owner, there since 1985), Janelle Loper, Bridgett Williams.

THE POINT

I am not selling today

Whoever is at that desk cannot say yes. They can say no, by taking the sheet and binning it. **The job is to make them want to carry it back to Dr. Sanford.**

Everything below serves that.

- **Go between 2 and 4.** Mornings are surgery and drop-offs, lunch is pickups, after 4:30 everyone is trying to leave. Not Saturday — they shut at noon.
- **Carry:** laptop charged with the preview already open on the home page, two printed one-sheets, the site loaded on my phone as a backup.

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The opening

Do not ask for the owner. That is the telemarketer move and the shutter comes down.

"Hey — I'm Ryan, I live here in town. I build websites for local businesses. I wasn't going to bother y'all, but I noticed a couple of your listings online have the wrong address, and while I was looking I ended up building out what a new site could look like for you. Can I show you real quick? It's got your doctors on it."

Three things doing work: I am local, I found a problem that is *theirs* rather than a product that is mine, and "it's got your doctors on it" is curiosity nobody refuses.

Open the laptop and shut up

Let them scroll. Do not narrate. They will recognise Dr. Sanford, Dr. Loper, Dr. Williams and the sign out front, and that recognition *is* the pitch — it lands harder without me talking over it. When they react, one line:

"Everything on it came off your own site. I didn't make anything up."

The one question worth asking

Casually, while they are still looking:

"Who handles the website for y'all now — does the office pay for that, or does it come with the Vetsource account?"

Their site sits on *vetsourcecms.com*, and Vetsource makes its money on pharmacy margin, not subscriptions — no enrolment fee, no monthly charge, no cancellation fee on the core program. So it is very probably free to them and **I cannot win this on price**. If they say it costs nothing, agree, then pivot: it is free because it is a hook, it sits on a platform Vetsource no longer sells, and they do not own it. Say the thing that kills the objection before it is raised — **they can keep the Vetsource pharmacy and still own a proper website**. If it turns out they *do* pay for it, the whole picture inverts and it is a much easier sale.

Questions, not statements

Whoever is at that desk *lives* every problem on my list — she answers the phone at 7:31, she meets the person at the locked door on Saturday, she takes the after-hours calls. She is not the audience, she is the source. **Do not tell her what is wrong. Ask, and let her tell me.** Then it goes back to Dr. Sanford as "a guy was asking about the Saturday thing" rather than "a guy was selling websites."

"Do y'all ever get people showing up Saturday morning before you open?"

Three directories say 7:30, they open at 8:00. She will say *yes, all the time* — and now the problem is hers, in her words, and I never corrected anybody.

"When somebody calls after hours — what happens? Where do they find that number?"

The strongest card, and it is not a marketing problem — it is a care problem, which is the only kind a veterinarian is required to care about. Their site says a vet is available after hours and never says how to reach one. They are not in the Hattiesburg emergency network, so that client drives 34 miles and does not come back.

"How much of the phone is people asking things that are already written down somewhere?"

Twelve staff, phone opens 7:30, boarding needs four weeks' notice for boosters.

"If y'all ever wanted to move the website, do you know what you'd be able to take with you?"

Proprietary platform, no real export, and Vetsource's agreement takes registrar access. Do not answer it — it is the question Dr. Sanford should be left sitting with.

"Is Dr. Carson still with y'all?"

I need the answer anyway, and it surfaces gently that a doctor's page may still be live who is not there.

Every one of these can be dropped. "I noticed X — does that cause y'all any trouble?" and if the answer is no, move on. Arguing a problem somebody says they do not have is how I lose the room. Explaining a man's business to him after forty years of running it is the other way.

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The ask

Small, and about them:

"I know this isn't your call, and I'm not trying to put you on the spot. Who's the best person for me to leave this with — and when are they usually around? I'd rather come back at a good time than bug anybody."

"I know this isn't your call" is the most important sentence of the day. It tells them they are not about to be trapped, and people help once they are not defending a gate.

Then hand over the one-sheet:

"There's a price on the back so nobody has to guess."

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Leave, and mean it

Get a name and a day, and write it down in front of them. Thank them and go. Do not linger, do not add one more thing. Be the person who was easy, not the person who would not leave. **Follow up Monday.** Cold deals close on the second or third visit, almost never the first.

CAREFUL

What not to do

- ✗ **Do not run down the current site in front of staff.** Somebody in that building may have picked it. "Built on a template, like most vet sites" — never "it's bad."
- ✗ **Do not leave the thirteen-page version.** One sheet. The long one is for when they ask for it.
- ✗ **Do not discount to keep the conversation alive.** The price is on the sheet. Dropping it in the doorway teaches them what the work is worth.
- ✗ **Do not ask for the doctor's cell number.**

If Dr. Sanford walks out himself

Same opening, then hand him the laptop and let him scroll. When he asks the price, say it plainly — **\$3,500, once, and the site is his**, with \$75 a month afterwards only if he wants me looking after it — and then stop talking. First one to fill the silence loses.

If he asks something I do not know, **"I don't know, let me find out"** beats a guess every time. He has run that practice since 1985 and will spot a bluff instantly. The other answer he will respect.

Three things I can answer if they come up

- **"Where did you get our doctors' photos?"** — from what the practice already publishes. Nothing goes live until they say so, and consent for every person shown is on the pre-launch list in writing.
- **"Will we lose our Google ranking?"** — no. Every old address redirects to its new page; that is included, not an extra.
- **"What's wrong with our listings?"** — Marion County Development Partnership says 1498 Hwy 98 East, US Companies says Old Hwy 98 E, and three directories have Saturday at 7:30 instead of 8:00.